

**Speaker 1:** So good afternoon again, I'm going to introduce myself quickly and then talk about this research. My name is [Name], I am in the [1st-5th] semester of [program] at [University] and I am a [student], so I am part of a laboratory that studies social changes.

And this research you are going to be interviewed for now is about the quality of relationships, both your current and past relationships and relationships in general, of people you know, what you know about relationships. And this research is by a professor from the Philippines and he is conducting it in some countries, so it's Brazil, France, there are others, let me just check for you. Let me see, I forgot. Yes, the Philippines, Brazil, France, the United States, these are the countries. And that's it, the interview is the same for you and your husband, they are the same questions, but we want to know your answers separately, so we won't use your name, your recording, your image, or anything, I'm recording just so we can write down the answers and use this data as the research data, okay?

**Speaker 2:** Okay, fine.

**Speaker 1:** So, it's anonymous research, voluntary, those things. And I'm going to start with the questions, okay?

**Speaker 2:** Okay.

**Speaker 1:** And if you don't want to answer, you can ask me to skip to the next one or just say, I'm not going to answer, if you want to end the interview at any time, it's up to you, no problem.

**Speaker 2:** Okay.

**Speaker 1:** So the first question is how old are you?

**Speaker 2:** I am [61-65].

**Speaker 1:** And how long have you and your husband been together?

**Speaker 2:** [41-45] years.

**Speaker 1:** Wow, a long time. And do you have children?

**Speaker 2:** Yes, [1-5].

**Speaker 1:** And who do you live with?

**Speaker 2:** Just me and him.

**Speaker 1:** Do the children no longer live with you?

**Speaker 2:** No, in fact, there is [1-5] child who lives next door, but is independent.

**Speaker 1:** And I wanted to know if your main source of income and your current profession?

**Speaker 2:** I am a retired [occupation]. My source of income is the [redacted].

**Speaker 1:** And then I'm calling [Partner's Name] your husband, so I wanted to know if I can call him husband, [Partner's Name]?

**Speaker 2:** Yes.

**Speaker 1:** So the first question, I wanted to know if you can tell your story, how you met, how the moment of passion was, how the relationship began.

**Speaker 2:** We met very young, I was about [16-20] to [16-20] years old and he was about [21-25]. And I had just ended a childhood relationship, practically from school. And then he was introduced to me by a mutual friend at my doorstep and that's how we started dating. And he was practically my first boyfriend because the flings I had before weren't really boyfriends, right, they were just crushes, let's say. And that's it.

**Speaker 1:** Are both of you from [Country]?

**Speaker 2:** He wasn't born in [Country], but was raised in [Country]. I was born in [Country].

**Speaker 1:** And how would you compare the quality of your relationship with the relationships of your friends? Comparison really, if it's better, if it's worse, or in terms of quality?

**Speaker 2:** Look, I don't know if it's better or worse, but the vast majority of our friends today are separated. They've been separated for some time now, right? Some say they are living better and I haven't had that experience and can't tell you.

**Speaker 1:** But just by being together, considering the relationship, right?

**Speaker 2:** Just by being together, let's say it's better because we're together, we're not separated. Yes, we get around things and try to live together as best as possible, right?

**Speaker 1:** And then the next question is about... It's the same comparison, but with past relationships. I know you told me you had schoolboyfriends, so is the comparison better?

**Speaker 2:** No, there's no way to compare.

**Speaker 1:** This relationship is serious, [21-25] years with children, family, and the others were from school.

**Speaker 2:** Exactly.

**Speaker 1:** I think that alone can be a comparison.

**Speaker 2:** Yes.

**Speaker 1:** And for you, what makes a relationship high quality? What are the characteristics?

**Speaker 2:** Oh, I think respect, well-being, being concerned about the other, empathy. I think this is fundamental in a relationship. And so, trying to work around situations and having a lot of resilience. Because we live through very critical moments in a relationship. Especially regarding children, financial conditions. So sometimes we have some really difficult situations, but it's about one giving in, right? Trying to work around it. And then, it's also about resilience, right? To keep going.

**Speaker 1:** And now, low-quality characteristics. What does a relationship need to have to be low quality?

**Speaker 2:** Low quality? Oh, I think demands, what else. Mainly, demanding a lot from each other without much empathy. I think that's it.

**Speaker 1:** Demands in terms of jealousy, possessiveness, demanding everything. You didn't buy this, you bought that.

**Speaker 2:** Exactly. Actually, it's about putting the responsibility on the other that belongs to both. I think it's that. Just one putting it on the other. Not sharing responsibilities equally.

**Speaker 1:** And for you, what is most important in a relationship and why?

**Speaker 2:** Most important is respect. Because I think without respect, without... It's treating the other as you would like to be treated. I don't know if it's respect, empathy. But I think if respect is gone... It's one of the things we always held for each other. We never disrespected each other. Respect is gone and the relationship is over. So when we're fighting or in a critical situation, we always go with a foot behind to not... Not cross that line that we already established, you know?

**Speaker 1:** Not go beyond the limit because of anger, right?

**Speaker 2:** Because of anger, exactly.

**Speaker 1:** Now, a question that, in my opinion, is the most fun to hear the answer to. What is love for you? If you could define it, what does it mean?

**Speaker 2:** Oh, love is caring for the other. It's taking care, I think it's care, companionship, you know? Love is mutual, right? It's giving and receiving mutually.

**Speaker 1:** And how important is it to have love in a relationship?

Because some people believe that love alone doesn't sustain the relationship. Some believe it's the opposite. So how important is love in the relationship for you?

**Speaker 2:** Love is what overcomes things, overcomes everything. The difficulties. Because in the heat of the moment, you... You argue, sometimes even disrespect a little. But when you remember, wow... We're together for a reason, we love each other, right? I think that's it.

**Speaker 1:** So it's fundamental, super important.

**Speaker 2:** Super important, of course.

**Speaker 1:** And how do you know that your husband loves you? What does he do that makes you say, wow, now I'm sure he loves me?

**Speaker 1:** He has an excessive concern for me, care, right? He's always... It's something that is even kind of, how do I say it, contradictory, right? Because he cares to the point of invading my autonomy, right? Sometimes he wants to do things for me, right? And that sometimes irritates me a bit, right? But I know that deep down that is a concern for me, right? He wants to do things his way, right? And I think that's a demonstration of love, right?

**Speaker 1:** And what are the challenges you face in your relationship?

**Speaker 2:** Oh, there are many. I don't know, like that. Stubbornness, daily stubbornness. We argue about such small, silly things, you know? Oh, because you know I like this, and you do it that other way, you know? These little things, I don't know.

**Speaker 1:** It's the routine things?

**Speaker 2:** The routine, exactly.

**Speaker 1:** So the next question seems a bit like this one, but I'll ask it. And if it's too similar, we'll move on to the next one.

**Speaker 2:** Do you and your husband have divergences or difficulties in the relationship?

**Speaker 1:** Divergences... Oh, sometimes I... Oh, I don't know, divergences in his attitudes, sometimes... I'm very picky, very annoying, sometimes I want... I see things one way that he doesn't see, he sees with another perspective, and then we start to argue, I say, no, you could do it this way, you could do it that way, you could treat the person this way, have a little more empathy, I don't know what, because he says, but it's not like that, blah, blah, blah. I think it's in that sense, of our divergences, you know?

**Speaker 1:** Difference of opinion, right?

**Speaker 2:** Yes, difference of opinion, exactly.

**Speaker 1:** And is it usually frequent or not?

**Speaker 2:** Yes, very frequent.

**Speaker 1:** Okay, and how do you resolve these divergences? Do you talk, do you stay silent, wait for it to pass...

**Speaker 2:** That's the issue, we don't wait in silence, we have that little argument right then and there, and then everything is fine again and it continues.

**Speaker 1:** So, the moment you externalize is the moment it happens, if it happened, you have a little argument, a more heated conversation, and then it passes?

**Speaker 2:** Exactly. And soon everything is fine again.

**Speaker 1:** And what are other ways to keep your relationship like this? Besides these little arguments, what else happens that you manage to keep the relationship the way it is?

**Speaker 2:** We have many common projects, right? Like trips, regarding the children, regarding the grandchildren. We have hobbies in common. So to speak, right, I think all of this is important for us to keep this relationship good.

**Speaker 1:** So, would you say that your relationship is good for you? And why?

**Speaker 2:** I think it's good because of the companionship. You have someone by your side, someone who understands you, despite everything, we are always discussing our problems, our relationship, right? And that's it.

**Speaker 1:** So, it's good because you have someone by your side and someone to share with, right?

**Speaker 2:** To share with, exactly.

**Speaker 1:** And do you believe that your relationship has changed something in you? And how?

**Speaker 2:** My relationship? I don't know how to answer that. I think not.

**Speaker 1:** Because, you see, from [21-25] years old to now, the person changes on their own, you know?

**Speaker 2:** Oh, no, I think we matured together, right? We have been growing together over the years, right?

**Speaker 1:** Yes.

**Speaker 2:** A lot has changed, obviously, right? A lot has changed, the way I saw the world before and how I see the world today. Maybe if I had the mindset I have today when I was younger, maybe we wouldn't even be together because sometimes I see myself in situations like

"Wow, why are we in this situation?... I don't have to stay in this situation", you know? But today the companionship, you know, what we have built is so much bigger than all of this, that I think there is no other way to be happy.

**Speaker 1:** And do you believe that your husband is the same person from the beginning of the relationship until now?

**Speaker 2:** He hasn't changed much, no.

**Speaker 1:** Is that good, is it bad?

**Speaker 2:** He's more stubborn, but I don't know. I don't know, I think not, I think he hasn't changed much, no.

**Speaker 1:** And this question is, I'm going to read it, but it's very similar to the next one, so I'm going to read it, but we can skip it. Is your partner the same way he was at the beginning of the relationship and why? Actually, it's the same. We can skip it. You feel safe in your relationship? Safe in your relationship?

**Speaker 2:** Yes, I feel.

**Speaker 1:** What makes you feel safe?

**Speaker 2:** I think maturity leads us to this security, the certainty that we are together and that we want to stay together.

**Speaker 1:** Now, I'm going to present a scale on the screen, for you to just say from one to nine how much you believe that statement is true. Then I'll share it, but I'll read it to you and tell you. Tell me if you can see it. Can you see it?

**Speaker 2:** Wow, so small.

**Speaker 1:** I'm going to read it, then. So, the statement is if your partner really listens to you from one to nine, one being not true at all and nine being completely true. How much do you agree with this statement?

**Speaker 2:** If he listens to me?

**Speaker 1:** Yes.

**Speaker 2:** It's very true. Seven.

**Speaker 1:** And why? Why not nine, why not one, why seven?

**Speaker 2:** Wow. How can I answer that? Why does he listen to me? He's always present in everything I, all our decisions, he's always questioning, he always wants to discuss the relationship, everything we do, he wants to talk about the subject, he wants to clarify things right and all, I think that's it.

**Speaker 1:** That was well answered, you knew how to answer. So, the next question is the same thing, but the statement is if your partner is concerned with your needs, also from one to nine.

**Speaker 2:** Seven, very true.

**Speaker 1:** Then, why also with this seven mark and not nine?

**Speaker 2:** Because the basic needs like my health, my well-being, food, he's always concerned. I don't... Is it concern or is it a... No, it's real concern. Sometimes I doubt, is it really concern? Or is it just to bother me.? No, he really cares, he cares about my well-being, my health, my food, right? But sometimes, he doesn't... Some other things, he doesn't really notice. I stopped doing something that was important to me, sometimes. Yes, I think that's it.

**Speaker 1:** I'm going to stop showing this on the screen and we continue. Now, there are two questions about sex life. So, if you don't want to answer, no problem. I'm going to ask one question and if you say yes or no, we can skip it. I wanted to know if you've had sex lately. Lately, it's up to you. If it was last month, last year, last week, lately, it's according to what you think.

**Speaker 2:** Less frequently than we would like to have.

**Speaker 1:** Got it. And then the next question. So, how satisfied are you with your sex life? And why? With the frequency you would like, why?

**Speaker 2:** Less frequent. The age issue, right? Menopause, some health problems that we have been facing for some time. And that's it.

**Speaker 1:** Now, I wanted to know how satisfied you are with your relationship in general. So, from everything you told me and everything you know about your relationship, I wanted to know how you feel. Then, I'm going to share again, because there are the words and you just

choose which word you believe in. There. These words, can you see them? Can I increase it here? It's from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied.

**Speaker 2:** Very satisfied.

**Speaker 1:** And then, the same question. Why very and not completely?

**Speaker 2:** I think because of the things we have already discussed, right? I think... How would I answer that? I think we demand so much from each other, right? I think... I don't know how to answer this question. Honestly.

**Speaker 1:** Well, that was the last question. Thank you very much for the interview.

**Speaker 2:** You're welcome.

**Speaker 1:** You found it strange and funny, but it's like that. It's a fixed script.

**Speaker 2:** Okay. Thank you very much.

**Speaker 1:** I'm just going to stop recording.

**Speaker 2:** Okay. You're welcome.